CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

BOOKKEEPER + ADVISORY IN THE AI ERA

Software reconciles the books while you sleep. The value moved up — to tax and advice with a license behind it.

★ TL;DR — NO — to plain bookkeeping. Median ~$51K (BLS $50,670) after a 6–12 month ramp, and BLS projects the occupation to shrink −6% by 2035 because software already does the categorization and reconciliation. The credentialed work above it is alive; the roadmap below is the way OUT of the data entry and UP, not in. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

OUR TAKE: NO — NOT IN 2027

MEDIAN ~$51K · TRAINING 6-12 months · AI RISK HIGH · CERTIFICATE

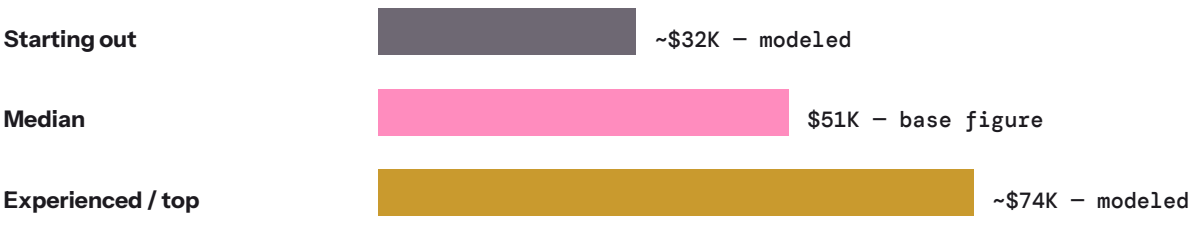
- Fails as a start because: bank feeds, auto-categorization and AI review now do the monthly close that junior bookkeepers were hired for — BLS names software automation as the cause of the decline.

- The money problem: a ~$51K median. The ~$75K figure in course ads is the occupation's top 10%, not its middle — and the billable hour for cleanup work shrinks as the software gets the first pass right.

- Still worth money: your fluency in a business's numbers. With a tax credential behind it, that fluency becomes advice clients can't get from an app.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Bookkeeper + Advisory is a ~$51K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state,

employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A BOOKKEEPER + ADVISORY ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Categorize transactions and reconcile accounts every month
- ✓ Run payroll entries, invoices and bill pay for small businesses
- ✓ Close the books and produce the reports owners actually read
- ✓ Flag cash-flow problems and answer 'can we afford this?'

Think: a lighthouse keeper after the lamp automated — the coast still needs pilots, but nobody hires for lamp duty.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Transaction categorization, reconciliation matching, invoice capture, standard reports — the monthly grind is a feature list of every accounting platform now.	Judgment on messy real-world books, tax consequences, and the owner conversation about what the numbers mean. Advice under a credential is the human layer.

⚠ **THE ADVISORY MIRAGE: courses sell 'bookkeeper + advisory' as the escape. Advisory without a license is opinions; the market pays for signatures and credentials.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Calm, structured, remote — numbers behave better than people ✓ Recurring clients and a predictable monthly rhythm ✓ You see the truth of many small businesses	✗ Not safe at the base: the entry tier is exactly what software ate ✗ Not respected as 'just the bookkeeper' — advice is where the status is ✗ Not season-proof: tax season owns your calendar if you climb — plan for it

Good fit? Already bookkeeping for clients who trust you — your book of business is the launchpad; the credential converts it.
Bad fit? Beginners planning to sell monthly cleanup as the whole business. That's the layer being deleted.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — PIVOT TO Enrolled Agent (tax pro)	DOOR B — PIVOT TO Accountant (CPA track)

A ~$55K category median (BLS Tax Preparers, $54,920, growing +5–6%) with the strongest moat in this family: the Enrolled Agent is a federal IRS credential that lets you represent clients before the IRS — something no app subscription includes. Credentialed EAs sit at the top of that category, and practice owners out-earn the median. Your bookkeeping clients already ask you tax questions; this makes the answers legal and billable. First move: map your current client list against their last tax season's pain — that's your first tax offer.	The full climb to an $83,680 median (BLS, Accountants and Auditors), with the top 10% above $144K: the license that owns audits, sign-offs and the senior seat in any finance room. It's a 2–4 year road, but every bookkeeping year you already have counts as a running start, not wasted time. First move: check your existing credits against your state board's CPA requirements and price the gap honestly.

Smart move: If you're already in: stop selling cleanup hours this quarter. Package one tax-season offer for existing clients — the credential path starts paying before the exam does.
Where you land after: You land where the numbers get signed — tax representation or the CPA seat — with software as your junior, not your rival.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
DRAW THE	PICK THE	START THE	CONVERT THE	REPRICE THE	SIT THE

STEP 1 — Draw the line at data entry

FREE · TODAY

- List your services; mark everything software now does unaided
- The unmarked remainder — judgment and advice — is the direction

STEP 2 — Pick the credential

FREE · 1 WEEK

- Compare the Enrolled Agent route vs your state CPA gap
- Choose by math: time, credits you hold, clients you can serve first

STEP 3 — Start the exam track

SELF-PACED · ONGOING

- Enroll in EA exam prep or the missing CPA courses
- Study in the hours cleanup used to take — the software freed them

STEP 4 — Convert the client base

FREE · 2–4 WEEKS

- Tell current clients what's coming: tax help under a credential
- Pre-sell one tax-season package to the warmest client

STEP 5 — Reprice the offer

FREE · ONGOING

- Drop per-hour cleanup from the menu; sell close + tax + advice as a bundle
- Let the software do the grind inside your own practice first

STEP 6 — Sit the first exam part

EXAM SEASON

- Pass part one of the credential — the market signal changes immediately
- Apply to tax/advisory seats or sign your first tax clients

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: split your service list into 'software does it' and 'only I can sign it.' Train for the second column.
- □ Days 1–30: choose EA vs CPA by the numbers; enroll; start prep in the freed cleanup hours.
- □ Days 31–60: tell clients the plan; pre-sell one tax package; bundle your offer around advice.
- □ Days 61–90: first exam part scheduled or taken; cleanup hours shrinking on purpose.
- □ Day 90: you're a credential candidate with clients converting — not a data-entry service racing software prices.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **GET THE LICENSE, KEEP THE NUMBERS** ★